KANSAS STATE UNIVERSITY | Libraries

February 10, 2026

David Molik
Head, Open Publishing Exchange
K-State Libraries

Dear David,

It is my pleasure to recommend to Dean Wiser that you be reappointed for another year. The Committee on Academic Tenure voted unanimously to support your reappointment with the following results:

- 19 Acceptable
- 0 Acceptable with Reservation
- 0 Unacceptable
- 0 Abstain

Below is a summary of themes and comments from your colleagues. These insights are intended to support your continued growth and success as you work toward future reappointment and eventual tenure.

Directed Service

Your directed service is consistently described as excellent. You are highly effective within your department, build strong collaborations across campus, and are viewed as a significant asset to the Libraries. You played a key role in guiding the transition from the former Center for Scholarly Publishing and expanding its focus and activities.

During the shift to the Open Publishing Exchange (OPE), you strengthened the unit's alignment with the university's research enterprise, particularly through support for FAIR compliance and your liaison work with OVPR and Research IT. Your contributions reflect growing institutional impact and thoughtful leadership during organizational and technical transitions.

Supervision

You are regarded as an effective and caring supervisor whose leadership style reflects patience, vision, and genuine concern for your team. Colleagues value how positively you speak about staff accomplishments and how thoughtfully you approach departmental needs and values.

Some reviewers noted opportunities for continued growth. At times, you may be overly conciliatory with supervisees, and they encourage you to ensure that you have trusted colleagues with whom you can discuss challenges candidly. Overall, your first year of leadership is strong, and with continued confidence and openness to addressing issues directly, your supervisory effectiveness will continue to deepen.

Open Publishing Exchange (OPE)

Your first year as Head of OPE has been exceptionally strong. Colleagues highlight your deep expertise in research and scholarly publishing, which has enabled you to identify researchers' needs and strategically reposition the former Center for Scholarly Publishing. You successfully led the rebranding to OPE, articulating a clear mission and reorganizing departmental work to better support university priorities, particularly around research data and publishing infrastructure.

Your leadership in developing strategic documents, initiating a data repository effort, supporting platform migration, and resolving complexities within the OATI program has been especially commended. Across all feedback, you are recognized for your vision, sustained effort, relationship-building, and ability to guide OPE toward increased visibility, relevance, and long-term success.

Non-Directed Service

You are excelling in non-directed service as well as in research and scholarship. Reviewers highlight your impressive role in co-founding a new journal and serving on its editorial board, demonstrating both scholarly expertise and a publisher's perspective on open-access work. You are active in prominent regional and national organizations, building relationships that strengthen your department and support K-State researchers. Your non-directed service portfolio is substantial, including participation in multiple national opportunities and university-level groups.

Research

Your research and creative work are viewed as exceptionally strong, particularly during a year marked by major career transitions. Reviewers repeatedly highlighted your three peer-reviewed publications and your success in securing multiple grants as PI or co-PI, noting that these accomplishments demonstrate a robust and growing scholarly profile. Your background in computational biology provides valuable insight into the challenges faced by K-State researchers and positions you well to support the university's research enterprise.

Reviewers expressed interest in seeing how you continue connecting your disciplinary research to library-focused work, including through initiatives like the Wildcat Scholars program, which may further integrate you into research processes across campus.

Portfolios

A significant number of comments addressed your portfolio. Reviewers agreed that your portfolio did not fully reflect the strength of your work and would benefit from clearer organization, more detail, and greater attention to

polish. Several noted issues with readability, clarity, repetition, and numerous typos. Many emphasized that summary sheets should be concise and professional, relying on bullet points rather than narrative paragraphs, and that sections would benefit from more concrete examples, clearer explanations of roles, outcomes, and committee work.

Reviewers recommend that you:

- Include dates throughout the portfolio so progress over time is clear.
- Embed links to evidence in relevant sections rather than placing them at the end.
- Clarify distinctions between directed service, non-directed service, and research/creative work.
- Expand or clarify UPP goals and ensure five-year goals follow the required format.
- Add context for committees, grants, and initiatives so reviewers understand their purpose and your contributions.
- Seek guidance from colleagues to improve formatting, flow, and proofreading.

Several reviewers noted that you yourself acknowledged feeling rushed and dissatisfied with your submission. They encourage you to take more time next year and seek help early, so your portfolio more accurately represents the strength of your work.

Reviewers also recognize that you are highly accomplished outside the library profession and encourage you to continue strengthening your foundation in library science. They recommend seeking additional learning opportunities to broaden your understanding of the field and further integrate your expertise into the library context.

Kudos

You are widely regarded as an exceptional addition to the Libraries. Colleagues consistently praise your professionalism, composure, and strong first-year performance. You bring rare depth, expertise, and strategic insight to the organization, contributing meaningfully to both the Libraries' culture and its research-focused mission. Your ability to build relationships, especially in areas where connections have historically been limited, has impressed many. Reviewers are especially appreciative of your energy in shaping a new department and strengthening cross-campus collaboration. You are viewed as a thoughtful, patient leader with strong momentum, and colleagues look forward to your continued contributions and future achievements.

Early Tenure

The committee believes you are progressing well and is impressed by your potential as a strong candidate for early tenure, possibly within the next two years. While several reviewers encourage you to consider going up early, they also advise approaching this thoughtfully and avoiding an unnecessary rush.

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Sincerely,

Tara L Coleman

Tara Coleman
Associate Dean for Collections, Technology and Innovation

I have met with Tara Coleman, Associate Dean for Collections, Technology and Innovation, and discussed the contents of this letter. My signature does not imply agreement with the contents of this letter.

Signature / Date

David C. Mobley Feb. 26th 2026